V+ & Cogniverai

2027 Coordinated Strategic Business & Marketing Plan

Oct 10, 2026

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Executive summary

In 2027, Strategic Value+ (V+) and Cogniverai should go to market as one system with two front doors. V+ sells readiness: getting small and mid-sized manufacturers qualified, compliant and capacity-ready through the Four Gates. Cogniverai sells AI adoption to aerospace and defense manufacturers through a coordinated bench of founding-member firms. Every V+ engagement should surface AI work for Cogniverai, and every Cogniverai engagement should surface readiness gaps for V+.

The shared story: *Ready for the AI-native supply chain.* JetZero broke ground in Greensboro in 2026 on a $4.7B plant it describes as AI-native, built with Siemens, Deloitte, Nvidia and AWS. The suppliers who feed plants like that will need to prove quality, cyber posture and flow, and to connect digitally. That is exactly the V+ plus Cogniverai offer.

Five moves for 2027

1. **One story, two brands.** V+ stays the readiness brand; Cogniverai is an endorsed brand, "convened by Strategic Value+," with V+ as orchestrator.
2. **A paid front door on each brand.** The V+ Constraint Diagnostic ($9,950) and a joint Cogniverai AI Readiness Diagnostic replace "free assessment" as the main conversion step.
3. **One partner program, not ten bespoke deals.** Standard referral tiers, lead registration and client-ownership rules for Cableteque, Meritus 360, Semantic OS, Jackson and Tull, ADACEN and the Cogniverai Consortium.
4. **Stand Cogniverai up properly.** A trademark filing (the USPTO search found no existing registration), a founding-member charter, a landing page and a North Carolina launch in Q1 2027.
5. **Protect the constraint, which is Nel's time.** Triage the project portfolio and gate in an operator to run delivery.

2027 targets (illustrative, calibrated in Section 9): about $1.15M gross revenue across both brands from 16 paid diagnostics, 6 Four Gates engagements, 3 Cogniverai engagements, at least 1 funded program and steady referral income, with at least 60% from commercial (non-grant) clients. The pro forma in Section 10 brackets FY2027 revenue between $405K (worst case) and $2.14M (best case), and stays profitable in all three cases because most costs flex with revenue.

Where we stand (October 2026)

V+ has unusual reach and a strong method, but too many open fronts and too little paid, repeatable work. Cogniverai has a strong bench and no market presence yet.

	Strengths to build on	Gaps to close
V+	Four Gates framework (AS9100, CMMC, TOC, ITAR) and V+ EDGE; Goldratt / Dr. Alan Barnard TOC partnership; Toyota and Northrop plant-floor credibility; HCNC, HUBZone, SBA, MEP and CSULB relationships; proven proposal engine (SCALE NC, SBIRs, CSOs)	Revenue is mostly contingent (referral splits, commissions, success fees); 20+ parallel initiatives compete for Nel's time; KDM separation still open (Southern University delivery terms)
V+ website	Clear promise ("Close the gaps. Win OEM business."), 4-step process, OEM-buyer page, affiliate page	Stat counters render as "0+"; the only testimonial looks like a placeholder; social links point to generic LinkedIn/Twitter/YouTube home pages; Google verification tag is unfilled; copy leans automotive/IATF while the pipeline is aerospace and defense; "free assessment" conflicts with the paid diagnostic
Cogniverai	Eight founding members covering leadership alignment, diagnostics, secure engineering, systems integration, logistics, immersive training and DoD-grade AI infrastructure; weekly partner meeting already running; Semantic OS cockpit concept	Not a legal entity; no site, no searchable presence; a USPTO search found no Cogniverai registration, so the mark is open to file; no packaged offer, price or client yet
Partner network	Live or near-live agreements with Jackson and Tull (40/60 net profit), Cableteque, Meritus 360 (meeting Oct 22), Semantic OS, ADACEN, TSC, Salt Technologies, RTB, E3S	Each deal has bespoke terms; no single view of referrals in and out

Bottom line: the next stage is not more partnerships. It is converting the network into a small number of paid, repeatable offers and a pipeline Nel does not have to carry alone.

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Market and timing

Four forces make 2027 the right year to lead with readiness plus AI, starting in North Carolina.

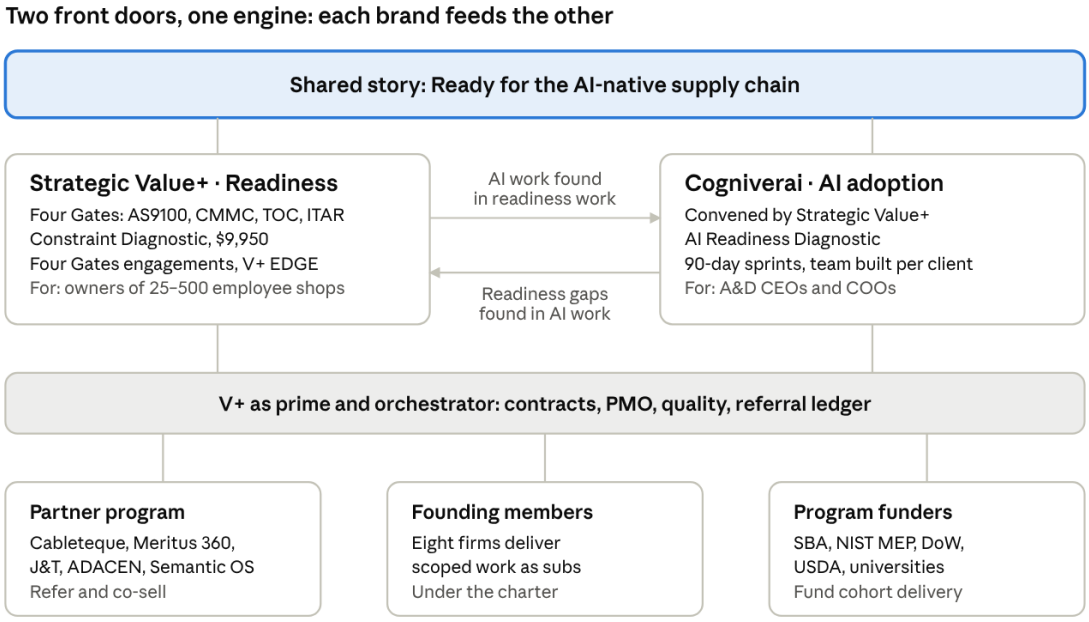
1. **North Carolina's aerospace build-out.** JetZero broke ground in June 2026 on an 8 million sq ft Z4 plant at Piedmont Triad International Airport, tied to roughly 14,500 jobs over ten years (Evertiq, Propmodo). Its demonstrator is due to fly in 2027 and its HQ moves to Greensboro by early 2027. HondaJet and Boom already sit at the same airport, and JetZero is also designing military variants (tanker, transport). Some reporting notes hiring delays, so treat timing as a range, not a date.
2. **The AI-native factory sets a new supplier bar.** JetZero is building its plant on Siemens, Deloitte, Nvidia and AWS digital platforms. Suppliers will be pushed toward digital quoting, traceable quality data and secure data exchange, which is the overlap between V+ and Cogniverai.
3. **CMMC is paused, not gone.** DoW suspended Phase 2 (mandatory C3PAO assessments) on July 13, 2026; as of October the Reform Task Force report is still unpublished and Phase 1 self-assessments remain in force (SaltyCloud, McGuireWoods). DFARS 7012, NIST 800-171, SPRS affirmations and False Claims Act exposure are unchanged, and primes set their own supplier deadlines. Sell exposure and readiness, not a deadline.
4. **SMMs are being asked to adopt AI without a playbook.** Owners of 25 to 500-person shops hear AI from their OEMs, vendors and boards, but lack the leadership alignment, data, security and workforce to use it. A coordinated, vendor-neutral team is scarce, and that is Cogniverai's opening.

Geographic sequence: North Carolina (Piedmont Triad, then Charlotte and the Research Triangle) in H1 2027; Southern California (Long Beach, where JetZero builds its test aircraft, plus the CSULB and California MEP network) in H2 2027.

Strategic architecture

V+ is the engine and the readiness brand; Cogniverai is an endorsed AI-adoption brand that V+ convenes and contracts for. They share one story, one pipeline and one referral ledger.

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V+ and Cogniverai operating architecture

The two arrows in the middle are the point: each brand's diagnostic is designed to surface work for the other.

How money flows

- The client signs with V+ as prime for both brands' work.
- V+ pays founding members and affiliates for their scope, and keeps its own delivery fees plus an orchestration margin (rate to set; see Decisions).
- Partners earn referral fees by tier; V+ earns the same on work it sends them.
- Funded programs run through V+ as prime or as a named subrecipient.

Target customers

Five client profiles, in priority order. The first two pay the bills; the last three multiply reach.

#	Profile	Who signs	Trigger that opens the door	Lead brand
1	**A&D tier 2–3 suppliers, 25–500 employees**, NC first, then SoCal	Owner/CEO, VP Ops, Quality Manager	Chasing a JetZero, prime or defense award; failed audit; late deliveries; CMMC/FCA worry	V+

#	Profile	Who signs	Trigger that opens the door	Lead brand
2	**Growth-stage A&D and defense-tech manufacturers** (drones, robotics, advanced materials)	CEO, COO, CTO	Scaling from prototype to rate; board or investor pressure to "use AI"	Cogniverai, with V+ for ops
3	**OEM and prime supplier-development teams**	Supplier development, supply chain, procurement leads	Need more qualified suppliers in a region; supplier risk; onboarding a new plant	V+ ("For OEM Buyers")
4	**Program funders** (SBA, NIST MEP, DoW programs, USDA Rural Development, state workforce boards, universities)	Program officers, PIs	Open solicitations; cohort programs needing a delivery partner	V+ prime, Cogniverai members as team
5	**Channel partners** (software vendors, staffing and integrator firms, associations)	Partner CEOs	Their clients need readiness or AI help they don't deliver	Both, via one partner program

Named accounts already in motion (fold into profile 1–2 pipeline): Premier Manufacturing, CBM Precision Parts, Hoyle's Tire & Axle, Southern University, etc.

Offer portfolio and pricing ladder

One ladder, four rungs, shared by both brands. A client can enter on either side and climb on either side. Only the $9,950 Constraint Diagnostic is a set price; every other figure is a proposed starting point to test with the first five clients.

Rung	V+ offer	Cogniverai offer	Proposed price	Purpose
1. Low entry	30-min discovery call; online Four	Semantic OS AI Opportunity Scan (referral);	$500	Capture leads, qualify fit

Rung	V+ offer	Cogniverai offer	Proposed price	Purpose
	Gates Readiness Scorecard	executive AI briefing		
2. Paid diagnostic	Constraint Diagnostic (TOC)	AI Readiness Diagnostic: leadership, data, security, workforce (2–3 members)	$9,950 (set); $14,500–$19,500	The main conversion step; credit 50% toward rung 3
2b. Risk brief	Executive Exposure Brief: CMMC, DFARS 7012, FCA (with RTB)	—	$4,950–$7,500	Fast entry for defense suppliers
3. Core engagement	Four Gates qualification roadmap and execution (AS9100 with Meritus 360, CMMC with RTB, TOC flow, ITAR)	90-day AI Transformation Sprint; team assembled per client from founding members	$10K–$20K/month for 3–9 months; $90K–$180K per sprint	Main revenue
4. Recurring and upside	V+ EDGE subscription; gain-share on throughput gains; software referrals (Cableteque, Meritus 360)	Cockpit/platform subscription (Semantic OS); training seats; managed secure AI (AOCyber.ai)	Subscription or % of measured gain	Annuity revenue and antifragile upside
Program-funded	Supplier readiness cohorts (SCALE-style), MEP subawards, Southern University delivery	AI adoption cohorts for regional supply bases	Per grant budget	Reach many SMMs at low client cost

Packaging rules

- Every rung-2 deliverable ends with a priced rung-3 proposal and a referral list for the other brand.
- Free assessment on the website becomes "free 30-minute call," leading to the paid diagnostic.

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- Gain-share only after a diagnostic sets the baseline, and only for throughput (TOC) work where the gain is measurable.

Go-to-market engine

Five channels, weighted by how much revenue each should produce in 2027. The partner program and ecosystem channels lead because that is where V+ already has trust.

Channel	Share of 2027 pipeline	How it works	Owner
Partner program	30%	One agreement template, three tiers (below), lead registration in a shared tracker, quarterly partner review	Nel, then operator
Ecosystems and associations	25%	HCNC and HUBZone conference, Women in Manufacturing, Reshoring Initiative, American Defense Alliance, CA MEP and CSULB, NC regional chambers and community colleges; speak, sponsor a session, run a cohort	Nel
Account-based outreach	20%	300 named NC and SoCal A&D suppliers in Apollo; 3-touch sequences tied to content; weekly target review	Operator or BD contractor
Federal and program capture	15%	Bid only where V+ is named in the work, has a teaming partner, and the delivery fits the ladder; E3S and J&T as primes where they lead	Nel with capture partners
Thought leadership	10% direct, feeds all	Nel's & Roy's LinkedIn, webinars, panels, the quarterly brief (Section 8)	Nel & Roy, with content support

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One partner program, three tiers

- **Referral partner:** introduces a client, earns a standard referral fee on first-year fees.
- **Active partner:** helps close (joint call, proposal input), earns a higher rate. This matches what Nel wants in the Cableteque deal.
- **Delivery partner:** Cogniverai founding members and affiliates who deliver under V+ or alongside it, paid on their scope.

Existing bespoke deals (J&T 40/60, Semantic OS finder fee, ADACEN (?) commission) stay as signed and move onto the template at renewal.

Federal bid filter: pursue only when at least three of these hold: a known customer or prime, V+ named in delivery, a funded line, fit with the four-rung ladder, and a decision inside 6 months.

Marketing plan

One umbrella message, two brand voices, four message pillars, one calendar.

Positioning

	V+	Cogniverai
Promise	We make small and mid-sized manufacturers qualified, compliant and capacity-ready to win and keep OEM and defense work.	AI adoption for aerospace and defense manufacturers: leadership, technology, people and security, delivered by one coordinated team.
For	Owners and operators of 25–500 employee shops	CEOs and COOs who must show AI progress without betting the plant
Proof	Four Gates, TOC with Goldratt Research Labs, Toyota and Northrop floor experience, ISO 9001 auditor	Eight specialist founding members, vendor-neutral, DoD-grade security option
Tagline	Close the gaps. Win OEM business. (keep)	Proposed: Adopt AI. Keep control.
Relationship line	"Home of Cogniverai" in footer and services menu	"Convened by Strategic Value+" under the logo

Four message pillars (shared; every piece of content maps to one)

1. **Qualified:** AS9100, supplier qualification, audit readiness.
2. **Protected:** CMMC, DFARS 7012, FCA attestation risk, ITAR.
3. **Flowing:** TOC capacity, on-time delivery, quoting speed.
4. **Intelligent:** practical AI, data, workforce, secure infrastructure (Cogniverai).

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Fix the V+ site before any campaign (October–November 2026)

- Remove or replace the placeholder testimonial with a real, approved client quote or a short case story.
- Fix the "0+" counters or replace them with plain statements.
- Link real LinkedIn, YouTube and X profiles; complete Google Search Console verification.
- Rebalance keywords and hero copy toward AS9100, CMMC, ITAR and aerospace, keeping automotive as a secondary line.
- Change "free assessment" to "free 30-minute call" and add the Constraint Diagnostic as a named, priced offer.
- Add a Cogniverai page or link and a Partners page that explains the referral tiers.

Cogniverai launch kit (by January 2027)

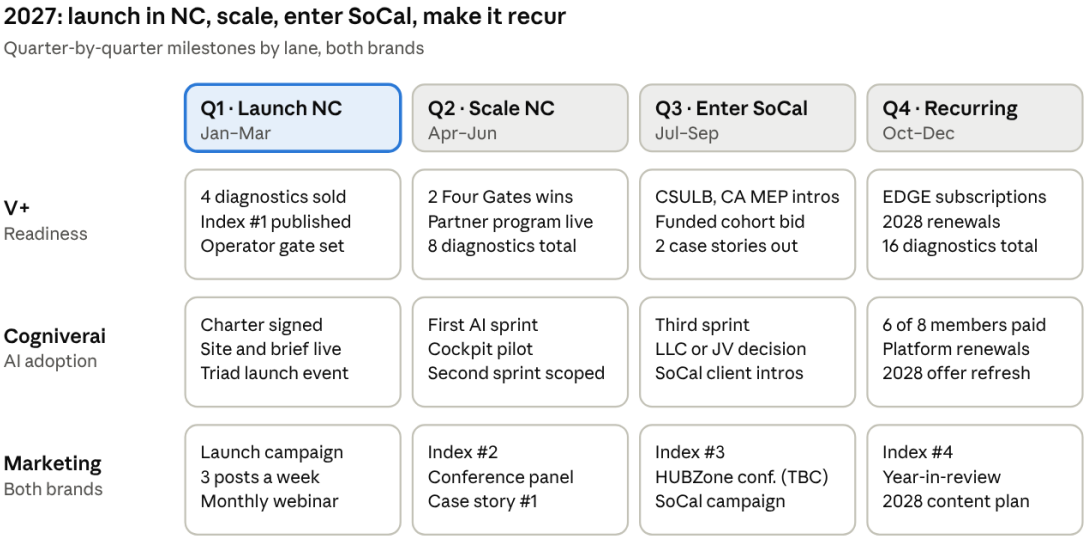
- File a USPTO trademark application for Cogniverai now (the search found no registration), and lock the domain and LinkedIn page before public use.
- One-page site: promise, the eight capabilities, how a team is assembled, AI Readiness Diagnostic, founding members.
- Founding-member logo wall and a two-page capability brief for primes and program officers.
- Launch event in the Piedmont Triad with a founding member and a local manufacturer on stage.

Content engine

- **Nel on LinkedIn:** 3 posts a week, rotating the four pillars; one long-form article a month.
- **Monthly webinar:** alternating brands (for example, "FCA exposure while CMMC is paused," "What an AI-native OEM expects from suppliers").
- **Quarterly "Supplier Readiness Index":** a short brief built from anonymized scorecard and diagnostic data. It becomes V+'s signature asset and a reason for press and primes to call.
- **Case stories:** one per quarter, starting with the first diagnostic clients.
- **Email:** monthly newsletter to the Apollo list and event contacts; 3-touch nurture after every webinar.

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2027 calendar at a glance



2027 roadmap · 3 lanes, 4 quarters

Q1 is the make-or-break quarter: if fewer than 4 diagnostics sell by March, revisit the price and the channel mix before scaling into SoCal.

2027 goals, KPIs and financial targets

The illustrative target is about $1.15M gross booked through V+, roughly $0.9M net after paying Cogniverai members for their scope. It is a model to calibrate against 2026 actuals, not a forecast; change the counts and prices and the totals follow.

Revenue build (illustrative)

Line	Count	Avg price	Gross
Four Gates core engagements (V+)	6	$70,000	$420,000
Cogniverai AI Transformation Sprints	3	$100,000	$300,000
Funded program (V+ share)	1	$150,000	$150,000
Constraint Diagnostics (V+)	12	$9,950	$119,400
AI Readiness Diagnostics (Cogniverai)	4	$15,000	$60,000

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Line	Count	Avg price	Gross
Referral fees and recurring (EDGE, software, J&T split)	—	—	$60,000
Executive Exposure Briefs	8	$5,000	$40,000
Total gross			**$1,149,400**

Assumes about 70% of sprint fees and 50% of AI diagnostic fees pass through to members, leaving roughly $909K net to V+. Commercial (non-grant) work is about 87% of gross, well above the 60% floor.

Scorecard

KPI	2027 target	Reviewed
Named target accounts engaged (reply, meeting or event)	400	Monthly
Qualified discovery calls	80	Weekly
Paid diagnostics sold (both brands)	16	Monthly
Diagnostic to core engagement conversion	≥ 40%	Quarterly
Referrals sent and received through the partner program	24 each way	Quarterly
Revenue from recurring or gain-share lines	≥ 5% of gross	Quarterly
Cogniverai members with at least one paid engagement	6 of 8	Quarterly
Published case stories	4	Quarterly
Share of Nel's hours on core (V+ readiness, Cogniverai, NC A&D)	≥ 70%	Monthly

Open question: 2026 revenue and margin baseline, needed to set the final target.

Pro forma financial plan (FY2027, with FY2028–FY2029 outlook)

V+ stays profitable in all three scenarios because its largest costs flex with revenue: Cogniverai member pass-through, affiliate delivery, and a contingent Founding Operator. The real worst-case risk is cash, not profit: closing cash of about $45K covers only 1.6 months of costs, so arrange a standby line of credit now.

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All statements are for Strategic Value Plus Solutions, LLC as prime for both brands, on a fiscal year matching the calendar year (Jan–Dec). The opening balances are placeholders and must be replaced with the actual Dec 31, 2026 figures.

Scenario drivers

Driver	Worst case	Most likely	Best case
Four Gates engagements (count × avg fee)	3 × $60K	6 × $70K	9 × $80K
Cogniverai AI sprints	1 × $90K	3 × $100K	5 × $120K
Funded programs (V+ share)	0	1 × $150K	2 × $150K
Constraint Diagnostics at $9,950	6	12	20
AI Readiness Diagnostics	2 × $15K	4 × $15K	8 × $17.5K
Executive Exposure Briefs at $5K	4	8	12
Referral and recurring income	$25K	$60K	$120K
CEO compensation (Nel)	$60K	$120K	$180K
Days to collect receivables	60	45	40
Revenue growth FY2028 / FY2029	25% / 25%	40% / 35%	60% / 45%

Common assumptions: members receive 70% of sprint fees and 50% of AI diagnostic fees; affiliates receive 30% of Four Gates and program fees and 15% of diagnostic and brief fees; referral fees paid are 3% of revenue; the Founding Operator earns 6% of revenue, contingent; fixed costs rise 10% a year; equipment and platform spend is depreciated over 3 years; subcontractors are paid in 30 days. As an LLC, V+ pays no entity-level income tax; 30% of net income is distributed for members' taxes. Opening balances (Jan 1, 2027): cash $40,000, receivables $25,000, net equipment $15,000, payables $10,000, members' equity $70,000.

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Pro forma income statement, FY2027

FY2027	Worst case	Most likely	Best case
Four Gates engagements	$180,000	$420,000	$720,000
Cogniverai AI sprints	$90,000	$300,000	$600,000
Funded programs	$0	$150,000	$300,000
Constraint Diagnostics	$59,700	$119,400	$199,000
AI Readiness Diagnostics	$30,000	$60,000	$140,000
Exposure Briefs	$20,000	$40,000	$60,000
Referral and recurring	$25,000	$60,000	$120,000
Total revenue	**$404,700**	**$1,149,400**	**$2,139,000**
Cogniverai member pass-through	($78,000)	($240,000)	($490,000)
Affiliate and partner delivery	($65,955)	($194,910)	($344,850)
Referral fees paid	($12,141)	($34,482)	($64,170)
Gross profit	**$248,604**	**$680,008**	**$1,239,980**
Gross margin	61%	59%	58%
CEO compensation (Nel)	($60,000)	($120,000)	($180,000)
Founding Operator (6% of revenue)	($24,282)	($68,964)	($128,340)
Content and BD contractor	($12,000)	($36,000)	($60,000)
Marketing and events	($20,000)	($45,000)	($75,000)
Cogniverai launch, trademark and legal	($8,000)	($12,000)	($15,000)
Software and tools	($12,000)	($18,000)	($24,000)
Travel (NC and SoCal)	($15,000)	($30,000)	($45,000)
Insurance	($8,000)	($10,000)	($14,000)

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FY2027	Worst case	Most likely	Best case
Legal and accounting	($10,000)	($15,000)	($20,000)
Other G&A	($6,000)	($8,000)	($10,000)
EBITDA	**$73,322**	**$317,044**	**$668,640**
Depreciation	($8,333)	($11,667)	($18,333)
Interest on line of credit	$0	$0	$0
Net income	**$64,989**	**$305,377**	**$650,307**
Net margin	16%	27%	30%

Pro forma balance sheet, December 31, 2027

Dec 31, 2027	Worst case	Most likely	Best case
Cash	$45,129	$157,304	$328,029
Accounts receivable	$66,526	$141,707	$234,411
Software, platform and equipment (net)	$16,667	$23,333	$36,667
Total assets	**$128,322**	**$322,344**	**$599,107**
Accounts payable (subcontractors)	$12,830	$38,580	$73,892
Line of credit	$0	$0	$0
Total liabilities	**$12,830**	**$38,580**	**$73,892**
Members' equity	**$115,492**	**$283,764**	**$525,215**
Total liabilities and equity	**$128,322**	**$322,344**	**$599,107**

Pro forma statement of shareholders' (members') equity, FY2027

FY2027	Worst case	Most likely	Best case
Opening equity, Jan 1, 2027	$70,000	$70,000	$70,000
Net income	$64,989	$305,377	$650,307
Member contributions	$0	$0	$0

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FY2027	Worst case	Most likely	Best case
Tax distributions (30% of net income)	($19,497)	($91,613)	($195,092)
Other owner distributions	$0	$0	$0
Closing equity, Dec 31, 2027	**$115,492**	**$283,764**	**$525,215**

Pro forma cash flow statement, FY2027

FY2027	Worst case	Most likely	Best case
Net income	$64,989	$305,377	$650,307
Add back depreciation	$8,333	$11,667	$18,333
(Increase) in receivables	($41,526)	($116,707)	($209,411)
Increase in payables	$2,830	$28,580	$63,892
Cash from operations	**$34,626**	**$228,917**	**$523,121**
Platform and equipment spend	($10,000)	($20,000)	($40,000)
Cash from investing	**($10,000)**	**($20,000)**	**($40,000)**
Member distributions	($19,497)	($91,613)	($195,092)
Line of credit draw (repayment)	$0	$0	$0
Cash from financing	**($19,497)**	**($91,613)**	**($195,092)**
Net change in cash	**$5,129**	**$117,304**	**$288,029**
Opening cash	$40,000	$40,000	$40,000
Closing cash	**$45,129**	**$157,304**	**$328,029**

Three-year outlook

Scenario	Metric	FY2027	FY2028	FY2029
Worst case	Revenue	$404,700	$505,875	$632,344
Worst case	Net income	$64,989	$105,080	$157,612
Worst case	Closing cash	$45,129	$103,484	$155,710

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Scenario	Metric	FY2027	FY2028	FY2029
Worst case	Members' equity	$115,492	$189,048	$259,974
Most likely	Revenue	$1,149,400	$1,609,160	$2,172,366
Most likely	Net income	$305,377	$516,950	$780,992
Most likely	Closing cash	$157,304	$341,792	$636,648
Most likely	Members' equity	$283,764	$516,392	$867,838
Best case	Revenue	$2,139,000	$3,422,400	$4,962,480
Best case	Net income	$650,307	$1,264,435	$2,008,916
Best case	Closing cash	$328,029	$783,602	$1,557,700
Best case	Members' equity	$525,215	$1,094,210	$1,998,222

What the numbers say

- **Receivables are the cash drag.** In the most likely case, $117K of profit sits in unpaid invoices at year-end. Require 50% deposits on diagnostics and monthly billing on engagements.
- **The worst case is survivable but thin.** Set up a $100K standby line of credit before Q1 2027; the model does not draw on it in any case.
- **Best case strains delivery before cash.** At 5 sprints and 9 Four Gates engagements, the bench and the operator, not money, become the constraint.
- **Not modeled:** owner distributions above tax distributions, any Cogniverai entity formation, and grant reimbursement lags. Replace the opening balances with actuals before using this for lenders or partners.

Operating model and governance

By V+'s own Theory of Constraints logic, the system's constraint is Nel's time. The operating model exploits it (Nel only sells, convenes and sets direction), subordinates everything else to it, and elevates it with an operator.

Roles

Role	Who	Owns
CEO, rainmaker, Cogniverai convener	Nel	Strategy, top 25 accounts, partner and funder relationships, keynote content
Founding Operator (60–90 day gate to COO)	?	Delivery scheduling, diagnostics QA, pipeline hygiene, NC field presence

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Role	Who	Owns
Delivery bench	V+ core team and affiliates; Cogniverai members per client	Scoped work under a V+ engagement plan
Content and BD support	Part-time contractor (to hire)	LinkedIn drafts, webinar ops, Apollo sequences, the quarterly index

Cogniverai governance

- **Form for 2027:** an unincorporated collaborative under a founding-member charter, with V+ contracting as prime and members as subcontractors. Revisit an LLC or JV once there are 3 paid engagements.
- **Charter must cover:** lead registration and who owns the client, fee splits by role, IP protection (including Semantic OS's cockpit concept), non-solicitation, quality standards, conflict-of-interest disclosure, and a clean exit for any member.
- **Rhythm:** keep the weekly partner meeting to 45 minutes on pipeline and staffing; one monthly working session on offers and content.

V+ management rhythm

- Weekly: pipeline and delivery review (operator runs it).
- Monthly: KPI scorecard and partner-referral ledger.
- Quarterly: plan review against this document, portfolio triage, price check.

Portfolio triage rule: every initiative is tagged Core, Adjacent or Outside.

- **Core:** V+ readiness, Cogniverai, NC and SoCal A&D, funded supplier programs, Southern University delivery.
- **Adjacent:** J&T drone and data-center alliance, ADACEN, federal SBIRs and CSOs as sub, HCNC and HUBZone on the Rise, ImmWorks. Pursue when they feed core clients or fund delivery.
- **Outside:** grant-writing services, SEO consulting, ESOP advisory, Africa minerals pursuits. Cap at about 15% of Nel's hours, hand to a partner, or close out.

Antifragility: risks and hedges

The plan uses a barbell: steady paid diagnostics and retainers on one side, small bets with capped downside and large upside (referral agreements, gain-share, funded programs, Cogniverai) on the other. Nothing in the middle that ties up cash or Nel's time without a clear payoff.

Risk	Early signal	Hedge
Founder bandwidth breaks before the pipeline does	Diagnostics slip; follow-ups go past 48 hours	Operator gate, productized offers, partner-delivered scope, triage rule

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Risk	Early signal	Hedge
Policy whiplash (CMMC Task Force outcome, budgets, shutdowns)	Task Force report; prime flow-down changes	Sell exposure and readiness, which matter whatever the date; keep commercial ≥ 60%
JetZero or NC timing slips	Hiring or supplier-onboarding delays	Spread across NC A&D, SoCal, defense tech and other OEMs; never sell "JetZero access"
Revenue stays contingent	Under 4 paid diagnostics by end of Q1 2027	Paid front door on both brands; credit toward core work; retainers over success fees
Cogniverai partner conflict or free-riding	Disputes over who owns a client	Charter with lead registration, fee table and exit clause; V+ as prime
Brand confusion or a trademark challenge	A similar mark is filed first; client confuses the two brands	File the trademark application now; endorsed-brand lockup; one shared story
Credibility hit from placeholder web content	A prospect asks about the testimonial or counters	Site fixes in October–November 2026, before any campaign
KDM separation spills into the market	Confused partners or clients	Short neutral statement; contract Southern University directly

90-day launch plan (October 2026 – January 2027)

The goal by mid-January: a clean website, a signed Cogniverai charter, a priced offer on each brand, and the first four paid diagnostics sold.

By October 31

- ☐ Fix the V+ site: testimonial, counters, social links, verification, "free 30-minute call" wording
- ☐ Send Cableteque the referral agreement with the active-partner rate
- ☐ Meet Brent Porter (Meritus 360) on Oct 22; propose the referral tier and an aerospace pilot
- ☐ File the Cogniverai trademark application and lock the domain and LinkedIn page (USPTO search found no registration)
- ☐ Make the Founding Operator decision with (?) and set the 60–90 day gate criteria
- ☐ Pitch the $9,950 Constraint Diagnostic to Premier Manufacturing

By November 30

- ☐ Circulate the Cogniverai founding-member charter draft at the weekly meeting
- ☐ Define the AI Readiness Diagnostic scope, price and which members deliver it

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- ☐ Publish the partner program one-pager and a shared referral ledger
- ☐ Build the 300-account NC and SoCal A&D target list in Apollo; launch the first 3-touch sequence
- ☐ Settle Southern University delivery terms directly
- ☐ Run webinar 1: FCA exposure while CMMC Phase 2 is paused (with RTB)

By January 15

- ☐ Sign the charter with at least 6 of 8 founding members
- ☐ Launch the Cogniverai one-page site and capability brief
- ☐ Book the Piedmont Triad launch event for Q1 2027
- ☐ Sell 4 paid diagnostics across both brands
- ☐ Publish the first Supplier Readiness Index from scorecard data
- ☐ Run the Q1 plan review: triage the portfolio and set final 2027 targets from the 2026 baseline, load actual opening balances into the pro forma, and confirm a $100K standby line of credit

Decisions Nel needs to make

1. **Cogniverai's form for 2027:** stay an unincorporated collaborative with V+ as prime (recommended), or form an LLC or JV now.
2. **V+'s orchestration margin** on Cogniverai work and the standard referral rates for each partner tier.
3. **AI Readiness Diagnostic price** and whether 50% credits toward the sprint.
4. **Whether Cogniverai becomes "Gate 5: AI readiness"** inside V+'s framework, or stays a fully separate offer.
5. **Portfolio triage:** which Outside initiatives to cap, hand off or close.
6. **2027 revenue target**, once the 2026 baseline is in, and which pro forma scenario to plan spending against (recommended: commit fixed costs to the worst case, hire against the most likely).
7. **Founding Operator gate criteria** for (Candidate?).

Sources

- JetZero breaks ground on aircraft factory in North Carolina — Evertiq
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